

VUNOTHO — INTERNATIONAL COMPETITION APPLICATION BLUEPRINT

Integrated Farmer Marketplace • Value Recovery • Pricing • Logistics • Offline-First Technology

Assessment: The previous application concept was strong, but it was not yet international-competition ready. The major upgrade is to make Vunotho a complete farmer-to-market operating system rather than simply a produce-listing app.

Enactus alignment: Enactus evaluates entrepreneurial leadership, innovation, business principles, and sustainable positive impact. Vunotho therefore needs evidence of all four, not technology alone. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search1■

1. THE BIG IDEA

Vunotho gives every farmer a pathway to value. A farmer should not have to find separate solutions for selling produce, discovering prices, finding buyers, arranging transport and deciding what to do with rejected or surplus produce. Vunotho brings these functions into one platform.

2. THE FARMER PROBLEM

- I have produce but cannot find a reliable buyer.
- I do not know the best available price.
- My produce is rejected because of appearance or oversupply.
- Transport costs make small sales uneconomical.
- Buyers are far away or unreliable.
- I have limited information about alternative markets or processing.
- I have little evidence of my transaction history when seeking future opportunities.

3. THE VUNOTHO SOLUTION

ONE APP → ONE VALUE CHAIN

Farmer registration → harvest listing → price intelligence → buyer matching → aggregation → transport coordination → collection → processing/value recovery → sale → payment record → impact tracking.

4. CORE FEATURES

Module	What it solves
Produce Marketplace	Finds buyers for available produce.
Price Intelligence	Shows relevant price information and buyer offers.
Value Recovery	Routes suitable surplus/imperfect produce to fresh, processing or other appropriate markets.
Transport Hub	Matches collections/deliveries and groups compatible loads.
Order Management	Connects farmer supply to confirmed buyer demand.
Digital Records	Tracks harvests, sales, quantities and payments.
Offline Mode	Allows core work without continuous internet.
Admin / Hub Dashboard	Manages farmers, buyers, orders, collections and impact.

5. THE TRANSPORT SOLUTION — A MAJOR DIFFERENTIATOR

Transport should not be treated as an afterthought. If a farmer has 50 kg available but transport costs more than the sale, the market connection has little value. Vunocho therefore adds a logistics layer.

- Farmer enters available quantity and collection location.
- System identifies nearby compatible orders.
- Compatible farmer loads can be aggregated into one collection.
- Vunocho/approved transporters receive collection requests.
- Buyer receives delivery status.
- Farmer receives confirmation and transaction record.
- Transport costs can be displayed before the farmer accepts the transaction.

6. PRICING INTELLIGENCE

- Show relevant market/buyer prices where verified data is available.
- Show buyer offers rather than presenting one unexplained 'correct' price.
- Show estimated transport cost before commitment.
- Show estimated net return after transport/fees.
- Allow farmers to compare available offers.
- Build historical transaction data to improve future decision-making.

Key innovation: Do not tell a farmer only “price = \$X”. Tell them “Offer A = \$X, transport = \$Y, estimated net = \$Z.” That helps them make a better decision.

7. BUYER SIDE

- Buyers create demand requests with crop, quantity, quality, location and deadline.
- Vunocho matches suitable farmer supply.
- Buyers can request aggregated quantities from multiple farmers.
- Orders can move through confirmation, collection, delivery and completion.
- Buyer history can support reliability and trust mechanisms.

8. VALUE-RECOVERY ENGINE

Vunocho should not define produce as simply 'good' or 'bad'. It should identify the best economically and safely appropriate pathway.

- Fresh-market pathway.
- Processing pathway — e.g., crisps, flour or drying where technically and legally appropriate.
- Animal-feed pathway for suitable by-products.
- Composting/organic recovery pathway for appropriate residual material.
- Record the quantity diverted from disposal.

9. OFFLINE-FIRST ARCHITECTURE

- Core farmer actions work without internet.
- Data is stored securely on the device.
- Actions receive a synchronization status.
- When connectivity returns, records synchronize with the central system.
- Conflicting records are handled using defined synchronization rules.
- Previously synchronized market information can remain available offline.
- The app should clearly show: Saved Offline / Syncing / Synced / Needs Attention.

10. TRUST & SAFETY

- Verified farmer and buyer profiles.
- Clear transaction status.
- Transparent fees and transport costs.
- Basic dispute/reporting process.
- Consent and responsible handling of personal data.
- Role-based access for farmers, buyers, drivers and administrators.

11. BUSINESS MODEL

- Small transaction/marketplace service fee where commercially appropriate.
- Aggregation and logistics coordination fees.
- Processing/value-addition margin through Vunocho centres.
- Buyer-side service packages for reliable sourcing.
- Optional premium analytics/services later.
- Physical value-added product sales.

The exact fees should be validated through the field interviews and pilot—not invented in advance.

12. WHY THIS IS MORE THAN AN APP

The physical Vunocho enterprise creates value from produce. The application creates the coordination layer that makes that enterprise scalable: it knows who has supply, who needs it, what it may be worth, how it can move, and what value pathway is available.

13. THE UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

“Vunocho does not only help farmers sell. It helps them decide what to do with their produce, find the best available value pathway, calculate the real economics, move the produce, and complete the transaction.”

14. WHAT MAKES IT INTERNATIONAL-COMPETITION LEVEL

- It addresses multiple connected constraints instead of one isolated problem.
- It combines digital innovation with a physical circular-economy enterprise.
- It is designed around real rural connectivity constraints.
- It creates measurable economic value for farmers.
- It can reduce avoidable produce loss through alternative value pathways.
- It creates opportunities for youth in processing, logistics, technology and aggregation.
- It has a scalable business model rather than relying only on grants.
- It can expand from potatoes to other crops after validation.
- It produces transaction and impact data that can demonstrate real outcomes.

15. BUT DON'T TRY TO 'SOLVE EVERYTHING' AT ONCE

This is the most important caution. Making the app contain every possible feature will not make it innovative. Enactus judges focus on realized outcomes, tangible impact and a sound business model. ■cite■turn0search1■turn0search18■

- Start with one geography.
- Start with 1–3 crops.
- Start with a small farmer cohort.
- Validate buyer demand.
- Pilot transport coordination.
- Measure actual savings/income recovered.
- Then expand.

16. MVP FOR VUNOTH0

- Farmer registration.
- Harvest/produce listing.
- Buyer requests.
- Offer matching.
- Price + estimated transport + net-return view.
- Collection request.
- Offline storage and synchronization.
- Order/transaction history.
- Admin dashboard.
- Basic impact measurement.

17. PILOT SUCCESS METRICS

Metric	Target to validate
Farmers actively using platform	Set after field research
Produce listed	kg
Produce successfully sold	kg / %
Produce diverted from disposal	kg
Average farmer net return	\$
Transport cost per kg	\$
Buyer repeat rate	%
Orders successfully fulfilled	%
Youth jobs created	number

Metric	Target to validate
Vunotho revenue / surplus	\$

18. ENACTUS SCORECARD WE SHOULD DESIGN FOR

- Entrepreneurial Leadership — field research, partnerships, risk management, adaptation and ownership.
- Innovation — integrated marketplace + value recovery + pricing + logistics + offline-first design.
- Business Principles — clear customers, revenues, costs, unit economics, partnerships and scaling.
- Sustainable Positive Impact — measurable changes for people, planet and prosperity.

These four areas are the core global Enactus criterion. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search1■

19. EVIDENCE WE MUST HAVE BEFORE INTERNATIONALS

- Before/after farmer income or net-return evidence.
- Verified quantity of produce recovered.
- Actual transactions through the platform.
- Actual buyer purchases or letters/agreements where appropriate.
- Transport cost/time comparison.
- Farmer retention/repeat usage.
- Revenue and cost records.
- Evidence of youth/women economic participation.
- User testimonials supported by records.
- Clear proof that the team changed the solution based on user feedback.

20. SCALING PATH

Stage 1: One community + potatoes.

Stage 2: Multiple nearby communities + tomatoes/onions.

Stage 3: Regional processing and logistics network.

Stage 4: Multiple crops and processing pathways.

Stage 5: Replicable Vunocho model across Zimbabwe and potentially other markets.

21. FINAL POSITIONING

Vunocho is not a farming app.

It is a farmer-to-value platform.

It connects **produce** → **price** → **buyer** → **transport** → **processing** → **payment** → **impact**.

Competition principle: The application is the infrastructure, not the trophy. The winning story will be the measurable improvement created because farmers used Vunocho.